

the screen. To be able to access these particular tools, you can place the cursor on the toolbar and wait till the Hand icon appears. Then it's merely a matter of clicking and dragging the toolbar to the left. In case you are unable to replicate this exactly as explained, just move your cursor under one of the dropdown lists in the main toolbar to access the Pan Hand. You should know that the smallest supported screen resolution for the UI in 3ds Max Design 2010 is 1024 x 768, but the recommended resolution is 1280 x 1024 or higher.

1.1.7 Docked and Floating Toolbars

Apart from the main toolbar, you also have several other floating toolbars that may or may not be visible above the viewport. Many of the toolbars are hidden by default. You can find and gain access to any such hidden by right-clicking on a blank space of an open toolbar and selecting the hidden toolbar from the context menu that appears.

All the toolbars apart from the ones already discussed tend to float over the viewports. Few of the major toolbars which do this are the Layers, Render Shortcuts, Snaps, Axis Constraints, and the Extras toolbars. But just like the other toolbars, you can dock these floating toolbars to any side of the UI or just hide them for better visibility of the viewports. You can resize them by clicking and dragging any of their edges.



The Flyout options for the Scale Button

1.1.8 Toolbar Flyouts

You should have already noticed that some of the tools in the main toolbar have a small arrow in the bottom right corner of the tool's icon. This particular arrow indicates that the tool is one of several offered in a flyout.

1.2 The Command Panel

For most of your basic work in 3ds Max, the Command panel is what you will be using the most. The Command Panel is a single entry point for most functions. The Command panel offers nearly all the tools for creating and editing in 3ds Max. Across the top of the Command panel, you'll see a set of six tabs, each displaying an icon. From left to right, the tabs are Create, Modify, Hierarchy, Motion, Display, and Utilities. If you place the cursor on a tab, you'll see a tooltip displaying the name of the tab. When you click a tab, the functions relating to the tab appear in the rest of the Command panel. Here's a brief rundown of what each tab offers: